

Body Mechanics and Patient Mobility

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Chapter 8: four ideas to connect

Alignment and ergonomics

Use a stable base, proper alignment, and available equipment to reduce injury.

Positioning and transfers

Assess ability, explain the plan, obtain help, and protect tubes, skin, and joints.

Range of motion

Use active or passive movement to support mobility, circulation, comfort, and function.

Aids and fall prevention

Use prescribed devices correctly while identifying fall risks and clearing hazards.

Put the chapter into safe practical nursing care

A safe move begins before anyone lifts or stands.

Assess the patient's strength and instructions, prepare equipment and the environment, and ask for enough help. Stop if the patient becomes weak, dizzy, painful, or unable to follow the plan.

- ✓ Assess mobility and fall risk
- ✓ Prepare equipment
- ✓ Explain the move
- ✓ Use enough assistance
- ✓ Reassess after positioning

RECOGNIZE → ACT → REPORT

**Assess before moving.
Use the equipment.
Stop when risk changes.**

Before moving on, explain the cue, your immediate action within scope, and the facts you would report.